

Day 58 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Economy (1): GST 2.0 Reform

READING MATERIAL

Covers GST 2.0 — the September 2025 overhaul of India's Goods and Services Tax slab structure, directly extending the syllabus's 'Goods and Services Tax' clause with the most significant GST reform since its 2017 introduction.

Q: When did the GST Council approve the GST 2.0 rate rationalisation, and when did it take effect?

A: Approved on 3 September 2025, by the GST Council; implemented from 22 September 2025.

Q: What is the new GST slab structure under GST 2.0, and which old slabs were abolished?

A: A simplified structure with two main slabs: 5% (the 'merit rate', for essential goods) and 18% (the 'standard rate', for most goods/services) — plus a 40% rate specifically for demerit/luxury/'sin' goods. The earlier 12% and 28% slabs were ABOLISHED.

Q: How many items saw rate cuts under this reform, and what was the broader goal?

A: Rate cuts on over 375 items — aimed at simplifying compliance, making taxation more transparent, and boosting consumption and investment.

Q: Which consumer electronics items moved from the 28% slab to 18% under GST 2.0?

A: Air conditioners, large televisions, washing machines, and refrigerators — a direct tax reduction for households.

Q: Which category of goods moved from 12% to 5% under this reform?

A: Many medicines, diagnostic devices, and other healthcare products — reducing costs for end users as well as hospitals, clinics, and distributors.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. GST 2.0's rate rationalisation was approved by the GST Council on:

A. 15 August 2025

B. 3 September 2025 ✓

C. 2 October 2025

D. 1 January 2026

Explanation: 3 September 2025. [medium, web-research]

2. GST 2.0 took effect from:

A. 3 September 2025

B. 22 September 2025 ✓

C. 1 October 2025

D. 1 April 2026

Explanation: 22 September 2025. [medium, web-research]

3. Under GST 2.0, which two GST slabs were abolished?

A. 5% and 18%

B. 12% and 28% ✓

C. 18% and 40%

D. 5% and 40%

Explanation: 12% and 28%. [medium, web-research]

4. Under GST 2.0, the 'merit rate' for essential goods is set at:

A. 0%

B. 5% ✓

C. 12%

D. 18%

Explanation: 5%. [medium, web-research]

5. Under GST 2.0, which rate applies specifically to demerit/luxury ('sin') goods?

- A. 18%
- B. 28%
- C. 35%
- D. 40% ✓**

Explanation: 40%. [medium, web-research]

6. Under GST 2.0, large consumer electronics like ACs and refrigerators moved from 28% to:

- A. 5%
- B. 12%
- C. 18% ✓**
- D. 22%

Explanation: 18%. [medium, web-research]

7. Under GST 2.0, many medicines and healthcare products moved from 12% to:

- A. 0%
- B. 5% ✓**
- C. 8%
- D. 10%

Explanation: 5%. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Time and Work

READING MATERIAL

Time and Work is the last of the 10 named Aptitude skills — after this, Part B moves to its Reasoning unit. Real exam evidence shows heavy use of 'trap' questions designed to look like they need complex math but actually resolve via a simple ratio.

Q: Method — inverse proportion (more workers, less time): 12 men complete a work in 36 days. In how many days will 18 men finish the same work?

A: Men $\times$ Days = constant (total work). $12 \times 36 = 18 \times x \rightarrow x = 432/18 = 24$ days. More workers means proportionally fewer days.

Q: Method — sequential combined work: A, B, C can complete a job alone in 8, 12, 16 days respectively. A and C work together for 2 days, then C leaves and B joins A. In how many more days do A and B finish?

A: Work rates: A=1/8, B=1/12, C=1/16 per day. In 2 days, A+C complete $2 \times (1/8 + 1/16) = 2 \times (3/16) = 3/8$ of the work. Remaining = 5/8. A+B's combined rate = $1/8 + 1/12 = 5/24$ per day. Days needed = $(5/8) \div (5/24) = (5/8) \times (24/5) = 3$ days.

Q: Method — wages split by share of work done: A can do a job in 10 days, B in 15 days. They work together for 5 days, then C finishes the remaining work in 2 days. Total payment for the whole job is Rs.5,000 — how should it be split?

A: Pay is split in proportion to how much of the TOTAL work each person actually did, not how many days they worked. In 5 days, A completes $5/10 = 1/2$ of the job, B completes $5/15 = 1/3$; together that's $5/6$, leaving $1/6$ for C to finish. Split of Rs.5,000 by work share: A gets $1/2 \times 5000 = \text{Rs.}2,500$; B gets $1/3 \times 5000 \approx \text{Rs.}1,667$; C gets $1/6 \times 5000 \approx \text{Rs.}833$. The key insight is the split follows WORK DONE, not days worked — C worked fewer days than B but did a comparable or different share depending on the rates, and pay tracks output, not time.

Q: Method — pairwise combined rates $\rightarrow$ solve for all three together: A+B finish a job in 12 days, B+C in 15 days, C+A in 20 days. In how many days can A, B, C finish it together?

A: Add all three pairwise rates: $(A+B) + (B+C) + (C+A) = 1/12 + 1/15 + 1/20 = 2(A+B+C)$'s rate. LCM=60: $5/60 + 4/60 + 3/60 = 12/60 = 1/5$. So $2 \times (A+B+C \text{ rate}) = 1/5 \rightarrow (A+B+C) \text{ rate} = 1/10 \rightarrow$ together they finish in 10 days.

Q: Trap question: If 9 spiders make 9 webs in 9 days, how many days does 1 spider take to make 1 web?

A: 9 days — NOT 1 day. Each spider makes 1 web in 9 days regardless of how many spiders work in parallel (they're not collaborating on the SAME web). This tests whether you recognize the rate-per-individual stays fixed, the classic trap being to assume the answer scales down to 1.

Q: Method — pipes filling and draining together: Two pipes fill a tank in 30 and 40 minutes separately; a third pipe drains it in 24 minutes. With all three open, how long to fill the tank?

A: Combined rate = $1/30 + 1/40 - 1/24$ (subtract the draining pipe's rate). LCM=120: $4/120 + 3/120 - 5/120 = 2/120 = 1/60$. So the tank fills in 60 minutes.

Q: Method — provisions lasting fewer days with more people (inverse proportion again): 1,000 soldiers have 70 days of provisions. If 400 more soldiers join, how long will provisions last?

A: People $\times$ Days = constant (total provisions). $1000 \times 70 = 1400 \times x \rightarrow x = 70000/1400 = 50$ days.

Q: Method — find the second worker's solo time from a combined time and the first worker's solo time: A and B together finish a job in 16 days; A alone takes 48 days. How long does B alone take?

A: B's rate = $(A+B)$'s rate - A's rate = $1/16 - 1/48 = 3/48 - 1/48 = 2/48 = 1/24$. So B alone takes 24 days.

Q: Trap question: If 5 persons complete 5 projects in 5 days, how long do 50 persons take to complete 50 projects?

A: Still 5 days — NOT 50 days. The ratio of people to projects stays the same (1:1), so the per-project time doesn't change; 50 people working on 50 projects is just 10 independent copies of the original 5-person/5-project scenario happening in parallel.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. 15 men complete a work in 24 days. In how many days will 20 men finish the same work?

- A. 16 days
- B. 18 days ✓**
- C. 20 days
- D. 30 days

Explanation: $15 \times 24 = 20 \times x \rightarrow x = 360/20 = 18$ days. [easy, authored]

2. A and B together can finish a job in 18 days; A alone takes 45 days. How long does B alone take?

- A. 24 days

- B. 27 days
- C. 30 days ✓**
- D. 36 days

Explanation: B's rate = $\frac{1}{18} - \frac{1}{45} = \frac{5}{90} - \frac{2}{90} = \frac{3}{90} = \frac{1}{30}$. B alone takes 30 days. [medium, authored]

3. If 7 workers build 7 walls in 7 days, how many days does 1 worker take to build 1 wall?

- A. 1 day
- B. 7 days ✓**
- C. 14 days
- D. 49 days

Explanation: 7 days — each worker's individual rate is unaffected by how many work in parallel on separate walls. [medium, authored]

4. Two pipes fill a tank in 12 and 15 minutes separately; a third pipe drains it in 20 minutes. With all three open, how long to fill the tank?

- A. 8 minutes
- B. 10 minutes ✓**
- C. 12 minutes
- D. 15 minutes

Explanation: Rate = $\frac{1}{12} + \frac{1}{15} - \frac{1}{20}$. LCM=60: $\frac{5}{60} + \frac{4}{60} - \frac{3}{60} = \frac{6}{60} = \frac{1}{10}$. Time = 10 minutes. [medium, authored]

5. 800 soldiers have provisions for 60 days. If 200 more soldiers join, how long will the provisions last?

- A. 40 days
- B. 45 days
- C. 48 days ✓**
- D. 50 days

Explanation: $800 \times 60 = 1000 \times x \rightarrow x = 48000 / 1000 = 48$ days. [easy, authored]

6. A, B, and C can do a job alone in 24, 30, and 40 days respectively. Working together, how long will they take?

- A. 8 days
- B. 10 days ✓**
- C. 12 days
- D. 15 days

Explanation: Combined rate = $\frac{1}{24} + \frac{1}{30} + \frac{1}{40}$. LCM=120: $\frac{5}{120} + \frac{4}{120} + \frac{3}{120} = \frac{12}{120} = \frac{1}{10}$. Together they take 10 days. [medium, authored]

7. If 8 people complete 8 tasks in 8 days, how long do 40 people take to complete 40 tasks?

- A. 8 days ✓**
- B. 20 days
- C. 40 days
- D. 320 days

Explanation: Still 8 days — the people-to-task ratio (1:1) is unchanged, so per-task time is unchanged. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Grammar: Sentence Patterns and Non-Finite Verbs (Verbals)

READING MATERIAL

Covers identifying sentence patterns using S(ubject)/V(erb)/O(bject)/C(omplement)/A(dverbial) codes, and distinguishing the three non-finite verb forms — gerunds, infinitives, and participles — which is exactly how TNPSC tests this material.

Q: Real exam: What is the sentence pattern of "In the hall, during prayer song, the students are silent"?

A: A+S+V+C (Adverbial phrase + Subject + Verb + Complement) — 'in the hall, during prayer song' is the adverbial, 'the students' the subject, 'are' the verb, 'silent' the complement.

Q: Real exam: What is the sentence pattern of "I placed the camera on the tripod"?

A: SVOA (Subject + Verb + Object + Adverbial) — 'I'=S, 'placed'=V, 'the camera'=O, 'on the tripod'=A.

Q: Real exam: What is the sentence pattern of "She made his intention clear"?

A: S+V+DO+C (Subject + Verb + Direct Object + Complement) — 'clear' is a complement describing the direct object 'his intention', not a second object.

Q: Real exam: What is the sentence pattern of "I painted the car blue"?

A: SVOC (Subject + Verb + Object + Complement) — 'blue' complements 'the car', describing the result of the painting.

Q: Real exam: What is the sentence pattern of "In 1998, Frank moved to London"?

A: ASVA (Adverbial + Subject + Verb + Adverbial) — 'In 1998' and 'to London' are both adverbials (time and place), bookending the subject and verb.

Q: Real exam: Identify the non-finite verb form in each — "Walking is a healthy habit", "I like to walk early in the morning", "Having walked a long distance I felt tired", "These are my walking shoes".

A: "Walking is a healthy habit" = GERUND (acting as the subject noun). "I like TO WALK early" = INFINITIVE. "HAVING WALKED a long distance..." = (perfect) PARTICIPLE, used adverbially to show a completed prior action. "...my WALKING shoes" = PARTICIPLE used as an ADJECTIVE (participial adjective), describing 'shoes' — all four confirmed via a real exam's match-the-following question.

Q: Real exam: Fill in the blank with the correct participle — "____ early, Pami had time to review her notes before the test."

A: "HAVING ARRIVED early..." — the perfect participle, showing an action completed before the main clause's action.

Q: What is the key difference between a gerund and a present participle, even though both end in '-ing'?

A: A GERUND functions as a NOUN (e.g., 'Walking is a healthy habit' — walking is the subject). A PRESENT PARTICIPLE functions as an ADJECTIVE or as part of a continuous verb tense (e.g., 'my walking shoes' — walking describes 'shoes'; 'she is walking' — part of the verb).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. What is the sentence pattern of "In the hall, during prayer song, the students are silent"?

- A. S+V+O
- B. A+S+V+C ✓**
- C. S+V+A
- D. A+A+S+V

Explanation: A+S+V+C. [hard, question-bank-2025]

2. What is the sentence pattern of "I placed the camera on the tripod"?

- A. ASVC
- B. ASVO
- C. SVOA ✓**
- D. SVOC

Explanation: SVOA. [hard, question-bank-2025]

3. What is the sentence pattern of "She made his intention clear"?

- A. S+V+O+C+A
- B. S+V+C+A
- C. A+S+V+O
- D. S+V+DO+C ✓**

Explanation: S+V+DO+C. [hard, question-bank-2025]

4. What is the sentence pattern of "I painted the car blue"?

A. SVOC ✓

B. SVC

C. SVA

D. SVOA

Explanation: SVOC. [medium, question-bank-2024]

5. What is the sentence pattern of "In 1998, Frank moved to London"?

A. ASVA ✓

B. ASVO

C. ASVC

D. SVIODO

Explanation: ASVA. [medium, question-bank-2024]

6. In "Walking is a healthy habit," the word 'Walking' is a:

A. Gerund ✓

B. Infinitive

C. Present participle

D. Past participle

Explanation: Gerund. [medium, question-bank-2024]

7. In "These are my walking shoes," the word 'walking' functions as a:

A. Gerund (noun)

B. Infinitive

C. Participial adjective ✓

D. Main verb

Explanation: Participial adjective. [hard, question-bank-2024]

8. Fill in the blank: " ____ early, Pami had time to review her notes before the test."

A. Have arrived

B. Having arrived ✓

C. Arriving

D. Arrived

Explanation: Having arrived. [medium, question-bank-2025]

9. What is the key functional difference between a gerund and a present participle?

A. There is no difference

B. A gerund functions as a noun; a present participle functions as an adjective or part of a verb tense ✓

C. A gerund is always plural

D. A present participle can only be used at the start of a sentence

Explanation: Gerund=noun; present participle=adjective/verb-tense component. [medium, authored]